NEIGHBOURWISE AI

Neighborhood Intelligence Report

East Boston

Boston, Massachusetts

62.8

out of 100

▲ Strength: **Grocery**

▼ Weakness: **Universities**

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

East Boston, a vibrant and diverse neighborhood nestled in the heart of Boston, Massachusetts, offers a unique blend of urban living with a strong community feel. With a master score of 62.8 out of 100, it's a solid choice for those seeking a balance of affordability and amenities. The neighborhood's top strength lies in its grocery options, scoring an impressive 86.7, ensuring residents have access to a variety of fresh produce and specialty foods. However, its proximity to universities is its weakest point, scoring only 23.4, making it less ideal for those seeking a campus-centric lifestyle.

East Boston is a haven for families and young professionals alike, offering a mix of affordable housing options, scoring 62.6, and decent schools with a score of 69.1. The neighborhood's safety score of 54.9, while not the highest, is still within a reasonable range, making it a suitable choice for those who prioritize a secure living environment. The area's robust public transit system, scoring 78.0, provides easy access to downtown Boston and beyond, making it a great fit for commuters.

However, the key trade-off in East Boston is its limited restaurant scene, scoring just 41.3. While the neighborhood boasts a few hidden gems, foodies seeking a wide variety of dining options might find the selection somewhat lacking. Despite this, East Boston's high Bluebikes score of 97.4 offers an excellent alternative for exploring the city or grabbing a bite in neighboring areas. In essence, East Boston is a solid choice for those who value a tight-knit community, easy commute, and access to fresh groceries over a bustling restaurant scene or proximity to universities.

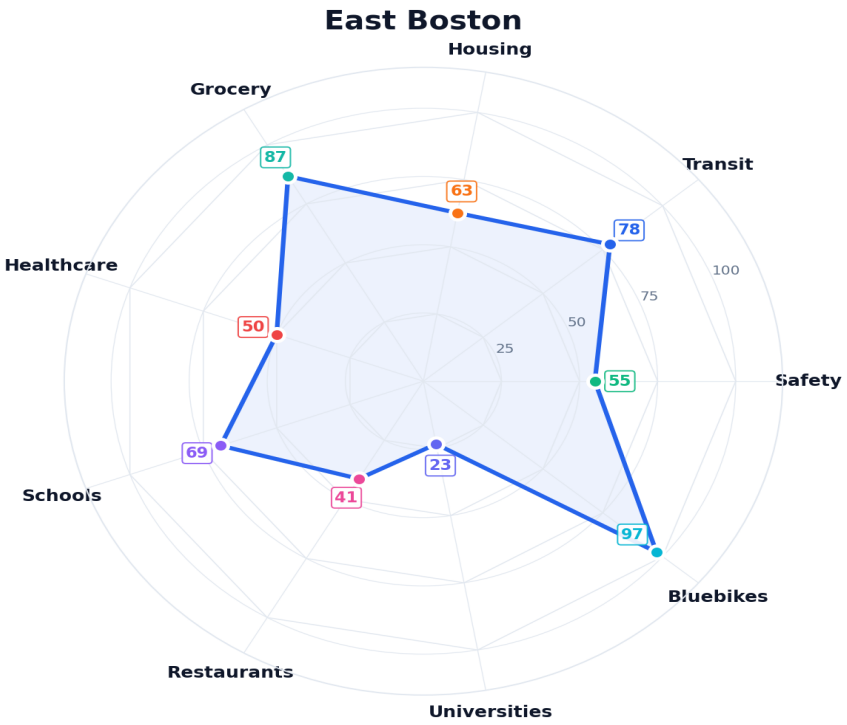
DOMAIN SCORECARD

DOMAIN	SCORE	GRADE
Safety	54.9	Good
Transit	78.0	Good
Housing	62.6	Average
Grocery	86.7	Abundant
Healthcare	50.0	Good
Schools	69.1	Good
Restaurants	41.3	Moderate
Universities	23.4	Limited

Bluebikes	97.4	Excellent

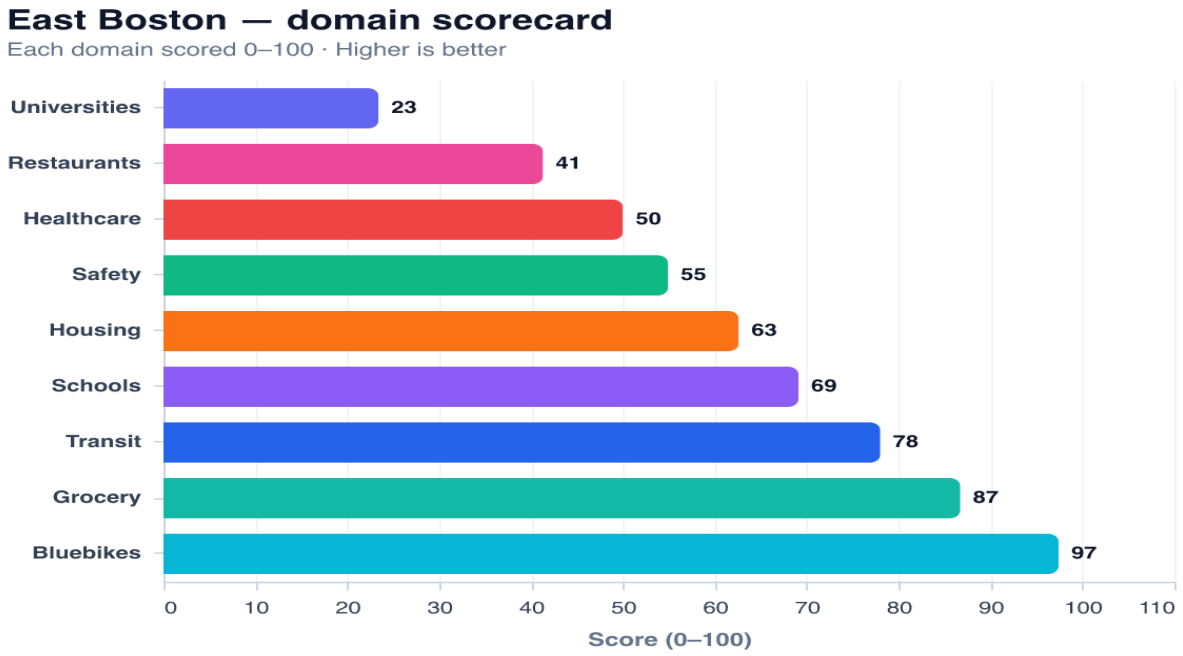
VISUAL ANALYSIS

Domain Radar



Each spoke represents one of the 9 scored domains (0–100).

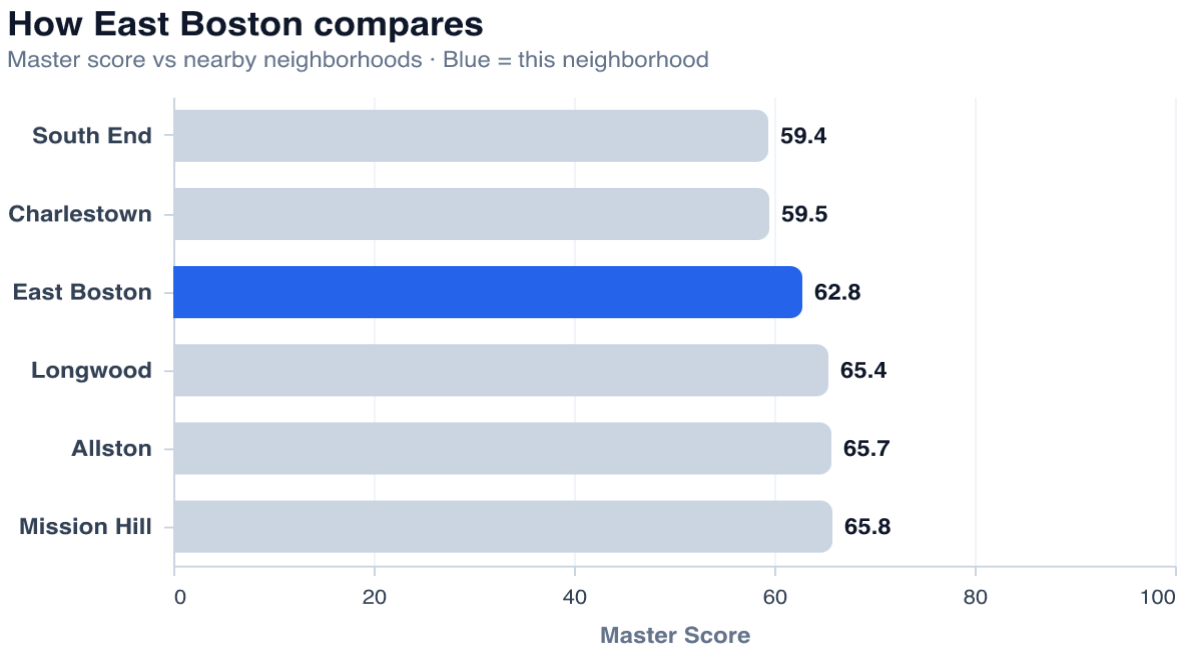
All Domain Scores



Color-coded by domain · Higher = stronger performance.

COMPARISON & TRENDS

Neighborhood Comparison



Blue bar = this neighborhood · vs 5 nearest by master score.

Crime Trend & Forecast

Blue = actual · Orange dashed = SARIMAX forecast + CI band.

Trend: Increasing · Model MAPE: 11.6% · Reliability: HIGH

East Boston has seen an uptick in crime, with an average of 361 monthly incidents over the past three months, compared to 306 in the same period last year. However, the ARIMA forecast predicts a slight decrease to 344 crimes by April 2026. Notably, 71.3% of these incidents occur within 25 dense crime hotspots, indicating that safety measures could be effectively focused within these areas.

DOMAIN ANALYSIS

● Safety

East Boston, a neighborhood within Boston, Massachusetts, has a safety score of 54.9 out of 100, indicating a relatively good safety level. The most common police service call is for sick assistance; however, the most prevalent actual crime type is property crime, accounting for 14.69% of all incidents. There has been a slight increase of 1.69% in total incidents year over year, with violent crimes representing a minimal 0.80% of all incidents.

● Transit

East Boston, with a transit score of 78.0, offers a good range of public transportation options. The area is served by the MBTA's Blue Line rapid transit, connecting East Boston to downtown and providing access to key destinations such as Logan Airport and the Nubian Station. In addition to the Blue Line, there are numerous bus routes, including connections to Wonderland, Haymarket Station, and the Hingham/Hull Ferry, with a total of 97 stops, 95 of which are bus stops. Notably, 96.9% of these stops are wheelchair accessible.

Restaurants

East Boston, a vibrant neighborhood in Boston, Massachusetts, offers a moderate restaurant scene with a diverse mix of cuisines, primarily across three categories. With a density of 132.48 restaurants per square mile, diners can choose from 624 establishments, of which 30.6% are high-quality eateries. The average rating of 3.37/5 indicates a satisfactory dining experience, with a price mix favoring budget and mid-range options, and 43.6% of restaurants offering delivery services.

Universities

East Boston, a neighborhood within Boston, Massachusetts, offers limited educational access with a score of 23.4 out of 100. The area is home to a single institution, the East Boston Beauty Academy, which is a private vocational school. This school does not offer bachelor's or higher degrees, nor does it provide campus housing or doctoral research opportunities.

LIFESTYLE & CHARACTER

East Boston, a vibrant and diverse neighborhood, is a walker's paradise, living up to Boston's reputation as "America's walking city." With a dense concentration of residential, business, and cultural resources, a remarkable 74% of trips within the neighborhood are made on foot or by bicycle. This close-knit urban fabric fosters a unique sense of community and a lively streetscape, where daily life unfolds in a dynamic interplay of work, leisure, and commerce.

However, East Boston's transit equity paints a different picture. The neighborhood, predominantly home to Black and Latinx communities, heavily relies on slower and less convenient bus services. In stark contrast, subways and commuter rail lines primarily serve upper-income and White neighborhoods. This disparity becomes even more pronounced during peak hours, when transit trips into downtown Boston originating from the suburbs or wealthier neighborhoods have no room or standing room only by the time they reach Boston's poorer, predominantly minority neighborhoods like East Boston. This imbalance underscores the need for more equitable transit solutions in the city.

WHO SHOULD LIVE HERE?

1. East Boston is most suitable for young professionals due to its high transit score of 78.0, indicating easy access to public transportation for commuting to work, and a decent housing score of 62.6, suggesting reasonable housing options. The high Bluebikes score of 97.4 also points to an eco-friendly and active lifestyle that may appeal to this demographic.

2. Families might want to consider other neighborhoods due to the relatively low scores in schools (69.1) and healthcare (50.0). While the safety score is not extremely low, a score of 54.9 might still be a concern for families looking for a very safe environment for their children.